

Meet Wanda

If you are using Gnome, press [Alt] + [F2] then key in "free the fish"

Benevolent dictators for life

A few leaders of the Open Source community are given this improbable title. Slackware creator Patrick Volkerding, and Guido Rossum who gave the world Python are two of them



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A look at a how open source design ideas that are treating waste as a resource, and neat ideas on useful things you can make with PC components

Open design and free culture

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Open source is a much maligned buzzword, if you go by an essay written by Richard Stallman (Why open source misses the point of free software). It respectfully corrects Wired magazine author Neal Stephenson, in a cultural critique that stresses on the difference between free and open source software.

What's the distinction? Free software is gives you the freedom to run, study, change, and redistribute code. Open source is well, a buzzword, and a development methodology. There can be specific licensing agreements that limit what can be done with that code, "Mali-

cious features, such as spying on the users, restricting the users, back doors, and imposed upgrades are common in proprietary software"

While the Android OS is free, the services that run on it are not: this came as a rude shock to Android fanboys when Cyanogen received a cease and desist letter from Google for distributing a modified Android firmware that also bundled access to Google apps such as Gmail and YouTube. Running Android on a device does not mean you get access to all applications.

Curd is open source

Finding low-cost, high value tech products that aren't neutered in anyway is an endless and often fruitless quest.

Part of my anticipation for Android has to do with my love-hate relationship with Apple – I like my iPod Touch, which came as an engagement gift, but if it weren't for Windows and IBM, my family would have not been able to afford a PC when it did.

As a veteran tech journalist, it feels sinful to support products that are expensive, incompatible, and full of proprietary software and connectivity screwups. iPods won't work without iTunes, and transferring videos is a pain. But it's amazingly fast. I was able to tap and see around a hundred photos in less than ten seconds. it's very responsive; an iPhone user has a typing speed of 83 words per minute! And the apps! I haven't purchased a single app yet (I don't use credit cards), and juggle with about three